

BigRed//Hacks 2026

General Information

October 2–4, 2026

Klarman Hall | Physical Sciences Building

Theme: **Navigation**

Contents

1	General Information	2
2	Team Formation	2
3	Emergency Contacts	3
4	Schedule	3
4.1	Friday, Oct 2, 2026 — Day 1	3
4.2	Saturday, Oct 3, 2026 — Day 2	3
4.3	Sunday, Oct 4, 2026 — Day 3	4
5	Workshops	4
6	Fun Activities!	5
7	Theme: Navigation	5
8	Our Sponsors	5
9	Tracks and \$7,000+ in Prizes	5
9.1	Main Track	5
9.2	Side Tracks	5
9.3	Sponsor Tracks	6
10	Submission Process and Judging	6
11	PSB Map	7

1 General Information

Check-In

Check-in starts at **6:00 PM on October 2nd** at Klarman Atrium, 232 Feeney Wy, Ithaca, NY 14850. If you are registered for the event and cannot make it to the check-in time, please let us know in advance so we can schedule a late check-in.

Food

If you would like to get food during breakfast, lunch, or dinner, please wear your shirt (provided at check-in) so we can have food for all the hackers!

Team Information

- Teams can consist of anywhere from 1–4 people.
- All projects **MUST be submitted by 8:30 AM on Sunday, October 4th**. Please note the unusual time. This allows us to prepare for preliminary judging to begin at exactly 9:00 AM. **We will not allow late submissions.**

Socials

- Instagram: **@bigredhacks**
- Event Discord: <https://discord.gg/5SRr3pm7N> — if you can't find an organizer in person, ask questions here and we'll answer as fast as we can!

Available Hardware

Thanks to our sponsors at MLH, hardware is available for your projects this weekend. Stop by the MLH table to see what's available and check items out with an organizer. The following can be rented for the weekend:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| • Raspberry Pi Kits | • Echo Dot |
| • Arduinos and Base Shields | • Assorted Bread Boards |
| • Logitech Webcams | • Wire cutters |
| • Google Home Mini | • Multimeter |
| • SenseCAP Indicator | • Assorted cables |
| • Echo Show | • Assorted Grove Components |

All returnable hardware must be returned by the end of the final judging round.

2 Team Formation

Teams can consist of 1–4 people. If you already have a team, fill out the team signup form by **Friday 10/2 at 11:59 PM**: <https://forms.gle/AA9s7pa7BAV7VE2i9>.

If you don't have a team yet, don't worry! You can find teammates through our Discord or fill out the form. We'll also have a team matching session Friday to help you find partners.

3 Emergency Contacts

Please reach out to any of the organizers (@BigRed//Hacks) on Discord if you have any questions prior to the event.

- **CUPD: (607) 255-1111**
- Calling 911 will result in delays as they transfer you from Tompkins County to Ithaca & Cornell emergency services.

4 Schedule

All times are in EST.

4.1 Friday, Oct 2, 2026 — Day 1

Time	Location	Information
6:00 PM	Klarman Atrium	Check-In Starts. Check in at the organizer booth to confirm your attendance.
7:00 PM	Goldwin Smith GSH 132	Opening Ceremony / Kick-Off. Mandatory: theme revealed. Speaker: Jon Kleinberg.
7:45 PM	Goldwin Smith GSH 132	Team Matching. Find teammates with similar project goals and interests.
8:00 PM	Klarman Atrium	Initial Check-In Ends. Spots open to the waitlist; first come, first served for Cornell students until capacity.
8:00 PM	Klarman Atrium	Dinner: Domino's Pizza
8:30 PM	Goldwin Smith GSH 132	Workshop: Figma
9:30 PM	Goldwin Smith GSH 132	Workshop: SpaceX Cursor
11:30 PM	PSB 120	GeoGuessr Competition
11:59 PM	—	Team Registration Deadline (mandatory): https://forms.gle/AA9s7pa7BAV7VE2i9

4.2 Saturday, Oct 3, 2026 — Day 2

Time	Location	Information
9:00 AM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Breakfast: bagels, donuts, coffee
10:30 AM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Raffle Draw!
11:30 AM	PSB 120	Sponsored Workshop by MLH
12:00 PM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Lunch: Chipotle

Time	Location	Information
12:00–2:00 PM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Career Fair — talk to our sponsors!
1:00–1:20 PM	PSB 120	Workshop: Photon Demo
2:00 PM	PSB 120	Workshop: Computer-Aided Design (CAD) by Assistive Tech
3:00 PM	PSB 120	Sponsored Workshop: A Data Science and Machine Learning Solution for a Hardware Problem by ASML
4:00 PM	PSB 120	Workshop: DTI
5:00 PM	PSB 120	Workshop: AppDev
6:00 PM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Dinner: Taste of Thai
7:30 PM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Raffle Draw!
9:30 PM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Cup Stacking Competition
11:30 PM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Spicy Ramen Competition

4.3 Sunday, Oct 4, 2026 — Day 3

Time	Location	Information
8:00 AM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Breakfast: bagels, donuts, coffee
8:30 AM	Devpost	Submit Projects. Allow at least 5 minutes — Devpost asks for a project description and tracks. https://bigredhacks2026.devpost.com/
8:45 AM	PSB	Team Numbers Posted. Go to the Physical Sciences Building, find your designated number, and prepare to present to judges.
9:00 AM	PSB Main Floor / Clark Atrium	Judging Begins
10:30 AM	—	Lunch: Sandwiches
11:30 AM	Baker 200	Finalist Demos
12:30 PM	—	Judging Finalized
1:00 PM	Baker 200	Awards and Closing Ceremony
2:00 PM	—	Hackathon Ends!

5 Workshops

If you're interested in learning more about hardware development, software development, or entrepreneurship, check out our workshops.

Day	Time	Location	Workshop
Friday	8:30 PM	PSB 120	Figma Make Workshop
Friday	9:30 PM	PSB 120	Grok/Cursor Workshop
Saturday	11:30 AM	PSB 120	MLH
Saturday	1:00 PM	PSB 120	Google Maps API
Saturday	2:00 PM	PSB 120	ASML
Saturday	3:00 PM	PSB 120	Assistive Tech
Saturday	4:00 PM	PSB 120	DTI Workshop
Saturday	5:00 PM	PSB 120	AppDev Workshop

Note: this table differs from the schedule above (Friday workshops listed in GSH 132 there; Saturday 1–3 PM order differs). Confirm with organizers or Discord.

6 Fun Activities!

Raffles: We will have raffles throughout the event and will hand out tickets randomly during workshops (**don't lose it!**). We'll announce when a raffle is about to happen, but there may be random ones throughout the weekend. The last raffle happens during the closing ceremony.

7 Theme: Navigation

- Theme information: [Theme Doc](#)
- [Opening Ceremony Slides](#)

8 Our Sponsors

We will have a **Career Fair** where you can talk to our sponsors on **Saturday 12:00–2:00 PM**.

9 Tracks and \$7,000+ in Prizes

9.1 Main Track

BigRed Track (3 winners). Every team is automatically entered. Projects are judged on all criteria, including technical, design, creativity, overall impact, and theme adherence.

9.2 Side Tracks

Software Track (1 winner). Evaluates the overall software and technical skill used in the project.

Hardware Track (1 winner). Evaluates the overall hardware, functionality, and technical skill used in the project.

Design Track (2 winners). Evaluates the overall visual presentation and UI/UX skills used in the project.

Beginner Track (2 winners). Rewards the best overall project created by first-time hackathon participants.

People’s Choice Track (1 winner). Rewards the best overall project voted on by hackers on Devpost during the event.

9.3 Sponsor Tracks

Capital One Track: Best Use of Nessie. Capital One challenges you to reimagine the banking experience by building an innovative application that leverages Capital One’s Hackathon API, Nessie (<http://api.nessieisreal.com>). Featuring access to mock financial data including accounts, merchants, bills, and peer-to-peer transactions, Nessie is your sandbox for solving real-world financial problems. We want to see projects that creatively integrate Nessie’s endpoints to empower users and improve their financial lives.

SpaceX Track: Make it Legendary. Space gives you more to work with than almost any other field. You have access to enormous public datasets, decades of missions, and a literature no human can read all of. Real space data goes in and a legendary project comes out.

- **Your project must be built with Cursor.** The more you use Cursor, the more likely you are to win.
- **You must use the Grok Imagine or Voice API.**
- Bonus points if you use Grok Bot for project planning and team collaboration.

Anyone who submits will be entered into a raffle for a Cursor Owala water bottle. Every member of the winning team receives a branded Cursor mechanical keyboard.

Photon Track: Agents in iMessage using Photon. Guidelines: [Hackathon Guidelines for Photon](#)

10 Submission Process and Judging

Sunday 10/4 8:30 AM — all projects must be submitted, no exceptions.

Devpost: <https://bigredhacks2026.devpost.com/>

Review the Devpost before submitting and set aside at least 5 minutes. You need:

1. A GitHub or Google Drive link to your entire project.
2. Your team’s deck for presenting to judges, as a **Google Drive link to a PDF**. It can include: project name and team members, problem statement and why it matters, your solution and demo screenshots, tech stack / how you built it, and impact and future potential.

Devpost will ask which tracks you are submitting to and for project details: Inspiration, What it does, How we built it, Challenges we ran into, Accomplishments that we’re proud of, What we learned, and What’s next.

At **8:45 AM** you will receive a team number; set up at that numbered table for judging.

Preliminary Judging — 9:00 AM, PSB Atrium

Science-fair style, **4 minutes per team**: 2-minute presentation and 2-minute Q&A. Your team will be visited by 2–4 judges at your table.

People's Choice

All projects are live on Devpost for public voting after 8:30 AM. Every participant may upvote their favorites; the project with the most upvotes wins.

Finalist Demos — 11:30 AM, Baker 200 Auditorium

- The top 5 teams in the BigRed Track present again.
- Each finalist has 4 minutes to present/demo and 2 minutes for questions.
- If you aren't called to present again, **that does not mean you didn't win a track**. Side-track winners are decided in preliminary judging and announced at the Closing Ceremony.

11 PSB Map

Map of the Physical Sciences Building. **Zone 6: Check-In Area.**

(Floor plan image BRH2016_PSB_floorplan.png not included — see the original General Info doc.)